Assignment 2 Report: Static Personal Blog Website

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1. Project Overview

This project develops a static personal website for Assignment 2 and deploys it in a form that can be accessed through a URL or an IP address. The final published version is a cat-themed personal blog named '猫猫没烦恼', which presents a homepage, a cat gallery page, and a curator page. At the same time, the website preserves Assignment 1 materials so that previous work remains integrated into the final site.

The published website URL is: https://cicisteady.github.io/assignment2_blog/

2. Website Setup and Deployment

2.1 Deployment Options

The assignment requires the website to be accessible through a URL or IP address. In this project, two deployment and access methods were prepared so the requirement is fully satisfied.

- GitHub Pages was used as the public deployment platform for the final online version.
- A local WSL HTTP server was prepared for local network access and testing before publication.
- The website can therefore be accessed both online and through local preview addresses.

Local preview addresses:

- http://localhost:8000
- http://<WSL_IP>:8000

2.2 Integration of Previous Work

The website includes direct download links to the Assignment 1 Markdown report and the Assignment 1 PDF report. These links are preserved on the cat gallery page so that the first assignment remains visibly integrated into the second assignment website, which directly satisfies the requirement to include links to the first assignment's Markdown report on the website.

2.3 Final Website Theme and Structure

Although the initial version was created as a general static personal website, the final published site was redesigned as a themed cats blog. The final structure consists of the following major pages.

Page	Purpose
Home	Introduces the cat blog, the curator name '猫猫没烦恼', and the overall site atmosphere.
Cat Gallery	Displays cat photos, short descriptions, and keeps downloadable assignment resources.
Curator	Explains the blog identity, the purpose of the site, and how to access it.

3. Version Control with Git

Git was used to manage the full website project. The repository history was organized into meaningful milestones rather than arbitrary save points. This ensures that each commit reflects a logical development step, as required in the assignment.

3.1 Meaningful Commit History

Commit	Message	Rationale
42590d9	chore: initialize assignment2 static site structure	Created the dedicated repository layout and the initial project scaffold.
d0d5348	feat: build responsive landing page and styles	Implemented the first complete homepage and shared visual style.
1efbdb3	feat: integrate assignment1 downloads and archive page	Added Assignment 1 links and preserved the earlier coursework inside the new website.
e90d711	docs: add assignment2 report and WSL command guide	Documented the build process and created reproducible WSL commands.
8768f33	chore: add local serving scripts and GitHub Pages workflow	Prepared both local preview and public deployment paths.
a8e4ba8	docs: expand step-by-step command reference	Improved the reproducibility of the project by expanding the command guide.
dbe2569	fix: update GitHub Pages workflow actions	Fixed deployment issues and updated the GitHub Pages workflow.
989a1ee	feat: retheme site as cats blog	Redesigned the website into the final cat-themed blog named '猫猫没烦恼'.

3.2 Rationale for Git Usage

- The initial commit established the repository structure.
- Feature commits added the website interface and integrated Assignment 1 materials.

- Documentation commits explained the workflow and preserved reproducible WSL commands.
- Deployment-related commits prepared GitHub Pages and local serving support.
- The final redesign commit changed the generic site into the final cat blog version without losing the assignment deliverables.

4. Documentation and Tool Choice

4.1 Markdown Documentation

The project process was documented in Markdown to explain the build steps, deployment steps, Git management process, and command workflow. This documentation was created so that the entire website could be reproduced from a WSL terminal with copyable commands.

4.2 Choice of Tools and Frameworks

A plain static HTML and CSS solution was chosen instead of Sphinx, Hugo, or another framework-based site generator. This decision was made because the current WSL environment already had Python 3 available but did not have pip and Sphinx ready to use. Using plain static files kept the project lightweight, reliable, and easy to deploy without introducing unnecessary dependency installation steps.

- HTML was used to create the page structure.
- CSS was used to build a responsive, themed visual design.
- Python's built-in HTTP server was used for local testing inside WSL.
- GitHub Pages was used for final public hosting.

5. Deployment Process

The deployment process included local testing inside WSL, SSH-based GitHub authentication, repository publication on GitHub, and GitHub Pages configuration through GitHub Actions. After the repository was pushed successfully, GitHub Pages deployed the site automatically and made it available through a public URL.

Representative WSL commands used during the process:

- cd /mnt/c/Users/r1382/Desktop/codex/assignment2_blog
- bash scripts/get_wsl_ip.sh
- bash scripts/serve.sh 8000
- git log --oneline --graph --decorate
- git push origin main

6. Requirement Checklist

Requirement	How It Was Satisfied
Website accessible by URL or IP address	The site is available through GitHub Pages and can also be previewed locally through localhost or a WSL IP address.
Integrate Assignment 1 report	Assignment 1 Markdown and PDF links were added to the website download section.
Use Git with at least 5 meaningful commits	The repository contains multiple meaningful commits reflecting setup, content, docs, deployment, fixes, and final redesign.
Document the entire process	A Markdown report and command guide were written, and this Word report summarizes the same process in formal form.
Explain tool choice	The report explains why a no-dependency static HTML/CSS approach was selected.

7. Final Submission Information

For final submission, the website link should be sent to the course staff email listed in the assignment instructions. The final website URL to submit is shown below.

https://cicisteady.github.io/assignment2_blog/

8. Conclusion

This assignment demonstrates the complete workflow of planning, building, documenting, versioning, and deploying a static personal website. The final result is a cat-themed blog called '猫猫没烦恼' that remains aligned with the course requirements by preserving Assignment 1 links, maintaining meaningful Git history, and remaining accessible through both public and local deployment methods.